

# AMERICA GOES TO WAR

## JANUARY 1965—SEPTEMBER 1967

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From early 1965, American military involvement in Vietnam rapidly escalated with the launch of Operation Rolling Thunder, a bombing campaign against North Vietnam and the Ho Chi Minh Trail, and the large-scale engagement of combat troops in the South. Under General William Westmoreland, the US Army and Marines employed a combination of firepower and mobility to find and destroy insurgents, a strategy that placed a heavy responsibility on ground troops. Yet sustained bombing failed to dent North Vietnam's will to fight and it proved frustratingly difficult to demonstrate that any decisive advantage had been gained from the strategy of attrition in the South. As American casualties increased at an alarming rate and rising troop levels required the extension of the draft, an initially small antiwar movement in the United States gathered momentum.